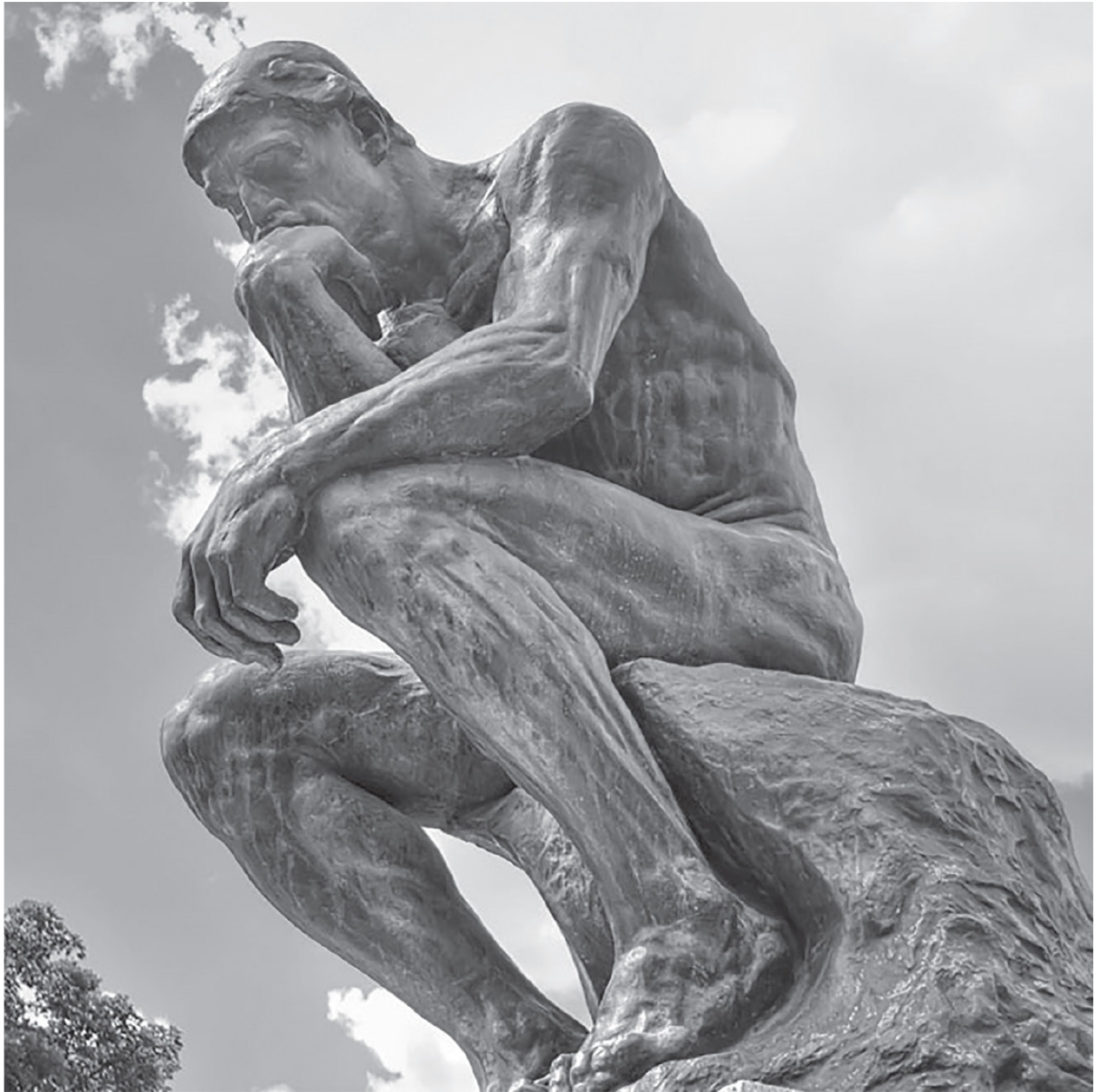


Rodin

One of the most influential artists of the late 19th and early 20th centuries was a sculptor, not a painter. Auguste Rodin (1840–1917) had traditional training and sought academic recognition, but was initially perceived as a rebel, and was rejected three times from the École des Beaux-Arts. After visiting Italy in 1875, he was inspired by the works of Donatello and Michelangelo, and on his return to France, he created *The Age of Bronze*, exhibited at the Paris Salon in 1877. In comparison with the idealized figures of prevailing Academic sculpture it caused great controversy for its realism – indeed, some thought it was cast from a living model – an illegal practice.

Yet once it was discovered that no underhand practice had taken place, Rodin became admired. He was commissioned to create various major projects for public institutions and became the pre-eminent French sculptor of the time. Expressive, dynamic and lifelike, his work later featured more unfinished surfaces to express even greater reality and movement.



Rodin, *The Thinker*, 1904